



networks and systems wide open is simply naïve.

Organisations look increasingly to security certifications to determine who is qualified to truly protect networks and systems. General multiple-choice certifications partially meet the need for such credentials. However, there is a need for a performance-based open source security certification like RHCSS that focuses on technical implementation, rather than policy or theory.

To this end, Red Hat offers the Red Hat Certified Security Specialist (RHCSS), a performance-based security certification that requires advanced skills using Red Hat Enterprise Linux, SELinux, and Red Hat Directory Server. An RHCSS can help your company meet the security requirements of today's enterprise environment.

Red Hat has long attracted industry notice because of live, performance-based testing in certification programs like Red Hat Certified Technician (RHCT), Red Hat Certified Engineer (RHCE), and Red Hat Certified Architect (RHCA). RHCSS joins this family as a first-of-its kind performance-based security certification.

What's expected of a certified RHCSS?

An RHCSS certified person is one who has demonstrated the expertise on technologies used to secure the Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL) operating system. Those certified have demonstrated skills in setting up a centralised authentication and user identity management in a heterogeneous environment using Red Hat Directory Server. As part of the certification process, these specialists will have written Mandatory Access Control policies in SELinux to lock down applications running on RHEL. The RHCSS modules also cover IPA (Identity, Policy, Audit), an integrated security information management solution combining Linux (RHEL), Red Hat Directory Server, MIT Kerberos, NTP and DNS. It consists of a Web interface and command-line administration tools. Currently, it supports identity management with plans to support policy and auditing management.

Why industry would prefer an RHCSS certified person

Industry has grown very rapidly in the past 10 years. Information security is quickly developing into a profession with a strategic focus that has grown beyond its IT roots. Certifications are a measure of experience and knowledge, and businesses increasingly like to see that certification in their employees.

Key aspects from a student's viewpoint

Information security is evolving as a career path. Changes in technologies, business needs, global threats and regulatory regimes have all had an effect on what it means to be an information security professional. One of the most direct paths to professional success in the information security field is through education.

One of the biggest changes we're seeing is that information security is being integrated into part of the overall risk management of an organisation. Overall, this means that information security will mature as a well-defined and strategic career path.

As we define what it means to be an information security professional, we must include the various certifications and understand how they fit into our profession. Being able to certify our capabilities is crucial to our ability to succeed. Whether you gain certifications for technical, management, policy and/or strategic skills, they are all key career building blocks. Whether you are a technical professional or a management/executive professional, certifications must be part of your career planning to put you on the path to success in this unique and challenging profession. 

How to get certified

Current RHCEs will obtain RHCSS certification upon successfully passing the following three Expertise Exams:

- EX333: Red Hat Enterprise Security: Network Services
- EX423: Enterprise Directory Services and Authentication
- EX429: SELinux Policy Administration

Examination fee

- EX333 - Rs. 10,000/-
- EX423 - Rs. 7,500/-
- EX429 - Rs. 7,500/-

Further details

Visit www.redhat.in/training/certification/rhcss, or write to training-in@redhat.com. To locate the nearest training institute visit www.redhat.in/training/locations.php